

Way to Hoko

"Naibong, my brother, you must go to Hoko; you are the youngest in our family. You are our future," soberly, a lady declared to a 13-year-old boy.

"I will go, sister," acknowledged Naibong.

In the day of 1946, Qina was experiencing the situation after the war of aggression from Japan, which is World War II. The government of Qina was dysfunctional. The fiat currency became worthless, the hyperinflation, and the rampant official corruption lost the heart of its people. Most of the wealthy people and those who were living near the seashores were trying to escape from Qina because the economy of Qina was broken down. Naibong's family was living near the southern border of Qina, which is near Hoko City. Hoko City was a peninsula of Qina, but it was not under the control of Qina for 106 years.

"It will be better than letting you stay here; you have nothing to eat and no future," said Naibong's brother. At that time the people who lived in the southern region of the country were also experiencing starvation and famine, where they were living.

"Brother and sister, how am I supposed to get to Hoko?" Naibong questioned.

The brother replied to him with a furrowed brow, "You probably need to go there by walking by land and transporting yourself to the railroad. The train will bring you into the city centre after you arrive, you need to find a job for yourself, especially the job that can provide place for you to stay."

"We will give you some food to eat on your way, and here is some money for you to buy a train ticket," his sister reminded, "use it wisely, Naibong."

"Thank you, brother and sister," he gratefully assured his older siblings.

"Are you going to visit your relatives?" questioned Jian.

"Not really, I'm going there to finding a job," answered Naibong. They chatted to each other. After a long time, Naibong raised his head and shouted, "Here is the train station; we arrived!"

"Naibong, thank you for bringing me here and the food you gave me. Oh! Oh, please wait here for a second. I will find my dad and ask him to pay you money for the food that you have given me." Jian said hurriedly in appreciation to Naibong with excitement.

"That's alright, you don't need to pay for the food. Since we were going to the same destination. I was heading this way anyway." Naibong quipped with a cheerful face. Then he turned away, not giving Jian a second to respond. He said, "Sorry, I am in a hurry. I need to leave now. Bye, hopefully we can meet each other again."

"Naibong!" Jian shouted, but Naibong soon disappeared in the crowd.

Naibong continued his journey without Jian. Now he was looking for a train station's ticket office to buy a ticket to Hoko. It took him a long time because the money he brought was not a stable currency, like the Hoko's currency was. He needed to wait until the price of the ticket to Hoko dropped before he could buy a train ticket. Because of the unstable fiat currency, the price of the ticket changed every single hour. When he finally got a ticket, an entire night had gone by. He finally stepped up to the train, He had finished all his food; he was hungry and had spent all his money for the train ticket. Meanwhile, the train was full of people and all their possessions; people could hardly get into the train. The train carriage was in total chaos because the railway company oversold their tickets as usual. Naibong looked around the train carriage; he could hardly move his body. When he stood in there for not knowing how many hours, the train finally stopped. People started to leave the train. Naibong asked the guard on the train, "Sorry, sir. Did we arrive at Hoko yet?"

"Not yet, kid; you still need to show your ID to pass through the border customs check and walk across a bridge to where the Hoko Preventive Service is. After you show your ID to them and let them check your bag, you just need to find the train that you need to transfer to. The train number probably shows on your ticket," the guard explained kindly.

"Thank you for your help, Sir," Naibong said gratefully. He followed the instructions of the kind guard and passed through it smoothly. He found the right platform and arrived in Hoko in the afternoon.